

Since +Post ads let you to take a piece of your public Google+ content, like a photo or video, and turn it into an engagement ad that runs across the Google Display Network, you will be expanding your reach across the spectrum of the internet.

In addition to paid advertising, Google also has two other features: promoted Hangouts on Air and automatic post promotion. Hangout on Air with +Post ads lets users take specific actions before, during, and after the broadcast. Users can RSVP prior to the Hangout, watch the broadcast live, and view a recording after the event. In another vein, Brands using the +Post Ads product can also choose to automatically promote their most recent Google+ post, paying only when people engage with the content. And by engagement, they mean total engagement.

Google has shared some success stories about the +Post ads on its blog. For example for the launch of the 2014 Corolla, Toyota USA sought to drive consideration from a younger audience by promoting their Google+ content with +Post ads. For this campaign, Toyota USA saw a 50% higher engagement rate than the industry average for rich media ads. So even if your business might not be a marketing behemoth the size of Toyota, any Google optimisation will only increase your brand value and keep you at the top of the Google page rankings.

Unfortunately, only Google+ Pages with 1,000+ followers can create +Post ads, promote Hangouts on Air and automatic posts. Even so, it's no reason to lose heart. Reaching the 1000+ mark is possible without any paid advertisements, and needs a carefully thought out social media strategy and some effort to pay off.

After all, social media isn't rocket science. 